PIXIJOY

Global Android UI/UX Design Bible

Version 1.0

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1. Product Design Philosophy

PixiJoy should feel:

Beautiful · Fast · Playful · Premium · Simple · Trustworthy

The user should never feel that PixiJoy is technically complicated.

Core principle

> Make powerful things feel effortless.

Every screen should answer:

1. Where am I?
2. What can I do?
3. What should I do next?
4. What happened after I interacted?

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2. PixiJoy Design Personality

PixiJoy is a consumer-facing product, so the visual language should be:

Do

- Large visual content
- Strong imagery
- Generous spacing
- Soft surfaces
- Subtle depth
- Smooth motion
- Clear typography
- Friendly microcopy
- Contextual actions
- Minimal visual clutter

Don't

- Excessive gradients
- Excessive shadows
- Excessive borders
- Too many colors
- Too many buttons
- Tiny text
- Dense screens
- Unnecessary dialogs
- Long onboarding
- Aggressive animations
- Technical terminology

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3. Design Principles

PixiJoy follows these 10 principles.

P1 — Content first

The user's content is the hero.

UI should support the content, not compete with it.

P2 — One primary action

Every screen must have one obvious primary action.

P3 — Progressive disclosure

Show important controls first.

Reveal advanced controls only when required.

P4 — Immediate feedback

Every meaningful interaction must produce visible feedback.

P5 — Predictability

The same action should behave the same way throughout the app.

P6 — Recoverability

Users should be able to recover from mistakes.

P7 — Adaptive by default

PixiJoy must adapt to available window size rather than assuming a single phone resolution. Android currently recommends window-size classes and adaptive layouts rather than designing independently for every device.

P8 — Accessibility by default

Accessibility is part of the design, not a later QA activity.

P9 — Performance is UX

A visually beautiful application that freezes or loads slowly is not premium.

P10 — Native Android behavior

PixiJoy should feel like a first-class Android application.

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4. Design System

4.1 Spacing

PixiJoy uses a controlled spacing scale:

Token	Value
XS	4dp
S	8dp
SM	12dp
M	16dp
L	24dp
XL	32dp
XXL	48dp
XXXL	64dp

Default screen horizontal padding:

16dp

Large-screen layouts may increase outer margins while keeping content constrained.

5. Touch Targets

Interactive elements should provide a minimum comfortable touch area.

Default:

48 × 48dp minimum interactive area

The visible icon can remain smaller.

Example:



Do not make users accurately hit tiny icons.

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6. Corner Radius

PixiJoy uses a restrained radius system.

Component	Radius
Small control	8dp
Standard card	16dp
Large card	20dp
Bottom sheet	28dp
Dialog	28dp
Full pill	50%

Do not use a different radius for every component.

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7. Typography

PixiJoy uses a small, consistent type scale.

Purpose	Size
Hero	32sp
Large headline	28sp
Headline	24sp
Title	20sp
Body	16sp
Secondary	14sp
Caption	12sp

Typography hierarchy must be obvious without requiring bold text everywhere.

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8. Font Weight

Recommended:

- Regular → normal content
- Medium → labels
- SemiBold → important headings/actions
- Bold → major hero messaging only

Avoid making entire screens bold.

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9. Color Philosophy

PixiJoy should have:

Brand

- Primary
- Secondary
- Accent

Neutral

- Background
- Surface
- Surface variant
- Text primary
- Text secondary
- Divider

Semantic

- Success
- Warning
- Error
- Information

Color must communicate meaning.

Never rely on color alone to communicate status.

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10. Dark Mode

Dark mode is a first-class experience.

Do not simply invert colors.

Design separate light/dark tonal relationships.

Important:

- Maintain contrast
- Avoid pure white text everywhere
- Avoid pure black surfaces everywhere
- Preserve image quality
- Preserve brand identity
- Check icon visibility

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11. Dynamic Color

PixiJoy may support Android dynamic color where appropriate, but brand-critical surfaces must remain recognizable.

Brand identity should never disappear simply because the user has selected a system wallpaper.

12. Icons

Use a consistent icon family.

Rules:

- Same visual weight
- Same optical size
- Same alignment
- Consistent padding
- Avoid mixing icon styles

Primary icon size:

24dp

Secondary icon:

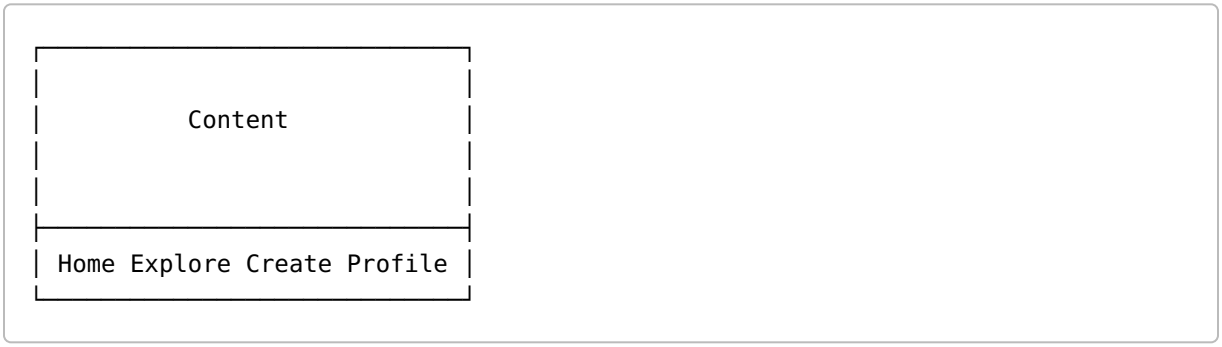
20dp

Hero icon:

32dp–48dp

13. Navigation

For compact phone windows:



Navigation should represent major destinations, not every feature.

For larger windows, PixiJoy should transition to an appropriate navigation rail or multi-pane layout rather than simply stretching the phone UI. Android's current adaptive guidance recommends changing navigation and pane presentation based on window size.

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14. Navigation Rules

Back navigation must always be predictable.

Typical hierarchy:

```
Home
 ↓
Feature
 ↓
Detail
 ↓
Editor
 ↓
Result
```

Back should normally return to the previous meaningful state.

Preserve:

- Scroll position
- Selected tab
- Filters
- Search state
- Drafts
- User input

---

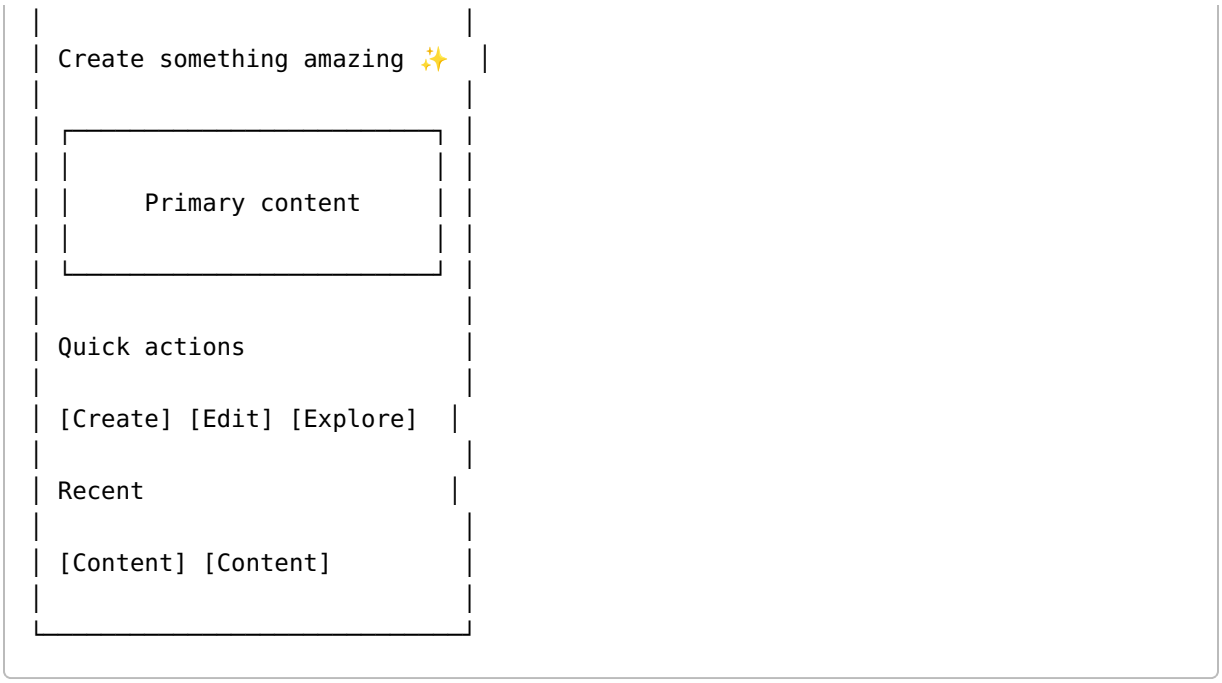
15. Home Screen

The home screen must immediately communicate:

What can PixiJoy do for me?

Recommended structure:

```
┌──────────────────────────────────┐
│ PixiJoy             Profile │
```



The actual layout should be finalized once PixiJoy's exact product features are frozen.

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16. Primary CTA

Every major flow must have one dominant CTA.

Examples:

Create

Continue

Save

Share

Apply

Generate

The primary CTA must visually dominate secondary actions.

---

17. Buttons

Primary

Used for the main action.

Secondary

Used for supporting actions.

Tertiary

Used for low-priority actions.

Destructive

Used for irreversible actions.

Do not use multiple primary buttons on one screen.

---

18. Cards

Cards should group related content.

Do not put every element inside a card.

Cards should have:

- Clear hierarchy
- Appropriate padding
- Consistent radius
- Clear interaction behavior
- Appropriate image aspect ratio

---

19. Bottom Sheets

Bottom sheets are preferred for contextual actions where a full screen is unnecessary.

Example:

```
Share

_____________________

WhatsApp
Instagram
Copy link
Save
More
```

On larger windows, the same interaction may become a side sheet where appropriate. Android's adaptive guidance explicitly recommends changing presentation rather than simply stretching components.

---

20. Dialogs

Dialogs are for important interruptions.

Use for:

- Destructive confirmation
- Critical decisions
- Important warnings

Avoid using dialogs for:

- Normal navigation
- Simple settings
- Routine information

---

21. Permission UX

Never request every permission immediately after launch.

Correct pattern:

```
User chooses feature
        ↓
Explain why permission is needed
        ↓
Android permission dialog
```

```
        ↓
Continue
```

Permissions should always have contextual justification.

---

22. Loading Experience

Every network-dependent screen needs a loading strategy.

Preferred:

```
Initial screen
      ↓
Skeleton
      ↓
Partial content
      ↓
Complete content
```

Avoid unnecessary full-screen spinners.

---

23. Empty States

Every collection must have an intentional empty state.

Example:

```
          ✨

Nothing here yet

Create your first PixiJoy experience.

       [ Create ]
```

An empty state should explain:

Why is it empty?

What can I do?

---

24. Error States

Never expose technical errors to normal users.

Bad:

`HTTP 500`

Better:

We couldn't load your content.

Check your connection and try again.

[Retry]

---

25. Offline Experience

PixiJoy must gracefully handle:

- No network
- Slow network
- Intermittent network
- Server failure
- Timeout

The UI must never appear frozen simply because the network is unavailable.

---

26. Micro-interactions

Important interactions should have subtle feedback.

Examples:

Like

```
♡
  ↓
♥
```

Save

```
Save
 ↓
Saved ✓
```

Upload

```
Uploading 63%
 ↓
Completed ✓
```

Animations should communicate state changes.

---

27. Animation Principles

PixiJoy animation should be:

Fast + purposeful + subtle

Guideline:

Animation	Target
Tap feedback	100–150ms
Small state change	150–250ms
Component transition	200–300ms
Screen transition	250–400ms

Do not animate purely because animation is possible.

---

28. Gesture Rules

Use familiar gestures:

- Swipe
- Drag
- Pinch
- Long press

- Pull to refresh

But never make a critical function gesture-only.

There must be an accessible alternative.

---

29. Image Rules

PixiJoy is visually driven, so imagery must be high quality.

Rules:

- Use correct aspect ratios
- Avoid unnecessary stretching
- Avoid visible low-resolution images
- Progressive loading
- Smart caching
- Thumbnail before full-resolution image
- Preserve focal point where cropping
- Handle failed image loading

---

30. Content Hierarchy

Every screen should have:

```
LEVEL 1
Primary message

LEVEL 2
Supporting information

LEVEL 3
Secondary information

LEVEL 4
Metadata
```

Users should be able to scan instead of reading everything.

---

31. Localization

PixiJoy must be designed for global localization from day one.

Never assume:

```
English text length = universal text length
```

Avoid fixed-width text controls.

Support:

- Long strings
- Short strings
- RTL
- Arabic
- Hebrew
- Asian languages
- Different date formats
- Different number formats
- Pluralization

Layouts must reflow naturally.

---

32. RTL

All layouts should support RTL.

Never hardcode:

```
left
right
```

when the concept is actually:

```
start
end
```

Icons that communicate direction must also be evaluated for RTL behavior.

---

33. Accessibility

Every major component must support:

- TalkBack
- Content descriptions
- Large text
- High contrast
- Touch targets
- Keyboard navigation where applicable
- Reduced motion considerations

Material 3's color roles and typography system provide accessibility-oriented foundations, but custom PixiJoy components still need explicit validation.

---

34. Large Text

PixiJoy must survive increased system font size.

Never allow:

- Clipped text
- Overlapping text
- Hidden buttons
- Broken cards
- Truncated critical information

unless truncation is intentionally designed.

---

35. Adaptive Layout

PixiJoy must not be designed around:

```
1080 × 2400
```

or any single phone.

The primary layout decision should be based on **available window size**.

Recommended conceptual model:

```
Compact
   ↓
Phone layout

Medium
   ↓
Tablet / foldable layout

Expanded
   ↓
Multi-pane / large-screen layout
```

Android currently recommends adaptive layouts based on window size classes and supports reflow, reveal and presentation changes.

---

36. Tablet / Foldable

Do not simply stretch the phone UI.

Instead:

```
PHONE

List
 ↓
Detail


TABLET

┌──────────┬────────────────────┐
│ List     │ Detail             │
│          │                    │
└──────────┴────────────────────┘
```

Use additional space for:

- Supporting information
- Preview
- Related content
- Editing tools
- Navigation rail

Material 3 Adaptive provides canonical patterns such as list-detail and supporting-pane layouts for exactly this purpose.

---

37. Edge-to-Edge

PixiJoy must be designed for modern Android edge-to-edge behavior.

Android 15+ enforces edge-to-edge for apps targeting SDK 35+, meaning content can draw behind system bars. Insets must therefore be handled deliberately.

Rules:

- Respect status-bar insets
- Respect navigation-bar insets
- Respect gesture insets
- Don't place critical controls underneath system UI
- Allow visual content to extend behind system bars where appropriate

---

38. Keyboard UX

When the keyboard appears:

- Focused field must remain visible
- Content should scroll appropriately
- Bottom CTA must remain usable
- IME dismissal must be predictable
- Correct keyboard action should be shown

Example:

```
Input
 ↓
Keyboard
 ↓
Continue remains accessible
```

---

39. Performance UX

PixiJoy must feel fast.

Target:

- No unnecessary blocking
- Smooth scrolling
- Minimal jank
- Efficient image loading
- Efficient animations
- Background work off main thread
- Proper caching
- Lazy loading for large collections

Perceived performance is as important as raw execution time.

---

40. Interaction States

Every interactive component must define:

```
Default
Pressed
Focused
Selected
Disabled
Loading
Success
Error
```

Example:

```
BUTTON

Default
Pressed
Loading
Success
Disabled
```

No component should have an undefined state.

---

41. Forms

Forms should:

- Minimize fields
- Use appropriate keyboard types
- Validate progressively
- Show errors near the field
- Preserve entered data
- Clearly identify required fields
- Avoid unnecessary validation interruptions

---

42. Destructive Actions

For dangerous actions:

```
Delete

This cannot be undone.

[Cancel] [Delete]
```

Where appropriate, prefer:

```
Deleted

[Undo]
```

over unnecessary confirmation dialogs.

---

43. Notifications

Notifications must be useful.

Do not notify users simply because the system can.

Notifications should be:

- Relevant

- Timely
- Actionable
- Non-repetitive

Notification content should make sense without opening PixiJoy.

---

44. Haptics

Use haptics selectively.

Good:

- Successful important action
- Selection
- Slider boundary
- Significant interaction

Bad:

- Every tap
- Every animation
- Every navigation event

---

45. Search

Search should:

- Open quickly
- Show recent searches where useful
- Provide useful empty results
- Provide clear loading state
- Preserve query when navigating back

Example:

```
Search PixiJoy
_____________________

Recent

Search results

No results?
```

```
Try:
"portrait"
"birthday"
"travel"
```

---

46. State Preservation

If the user leaves a screen temporarily, preserve meaningful state.

Examples:

```
Draft
Scroll position
Selected item
Filter
Search
Editor state
```

Unexpected state loss is one of the fastest ways to destroy trust.

---

47. UX Writing

PixiJoy language should be:

Friendly + concise + human

Instead of:

> Operation failed due to an unexpected exception.

Use:

> Something went wrong. Try again.

Instead of:

> Invalid input.

Use:

Please enter a valid name.

---

48. Onboarding

Onboarding should demonstrate value rather than explain every feature.

Preferred:

```
Welcome
   ↓
Choose / personalize
   ↓
First successful experience
   ↓
Discover advanced features naturally
```

The user should reach the product's "aha moment" quickly.

---

49. First-Time User Experience

The first session should optimize:

Time to first success

not:

Number of onboarding screens completed

---

50. Returning User Experience

Returning users should get:

- Recent content
- Continued work
- Useful shortcuts
- Personalized content
- Relevant suggestions

Avoid showing the same onboarding repeatedly.

51. Trust

PixiJoy must communicate trust around:

- Privacy
- Permissions
- User content
- Sharing
- Deletion
- Account management
- Payments if applicable

Never hide important consequences behind vague wording.

---

52. Premium Feel Checklist

Before a screen is approved:

Visual

- [ ] Correct spacing
- [ ] Correct typography
- [ ] Consistent radius
- [ ] Correct iconography
- [ ] Correct color hierarchy
- [ ] No unnecessary borders
- [ ] No excessive shadows

UX

- [ ] One primary action
- [ ] Clear navigation
- [ ] Immediate feedback
- [ ] Error recovery
- [ ] Empty state
- [ ] Loading state
- [ ] Offline state

Android

- [ ] Edge-to-edge
- [ ] Insets
- [ ] Gesture navigation
- [ ] Back navigation

- [ ] Font scaling
- [ ] Accessibility
- [ ] Dark mode
- [ ] Localization
- [ ] RTL
- [ ] Adaptive layout

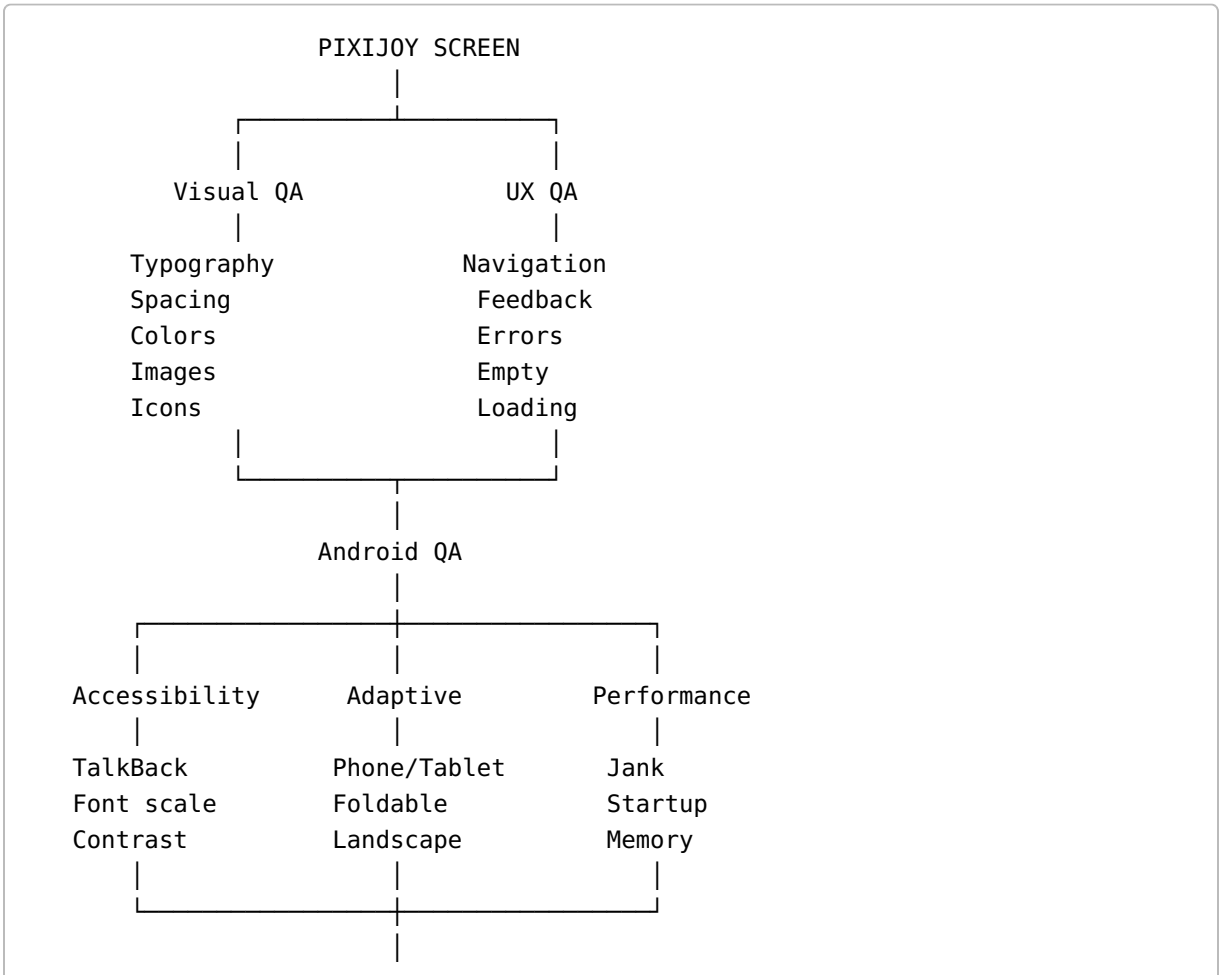
Performance

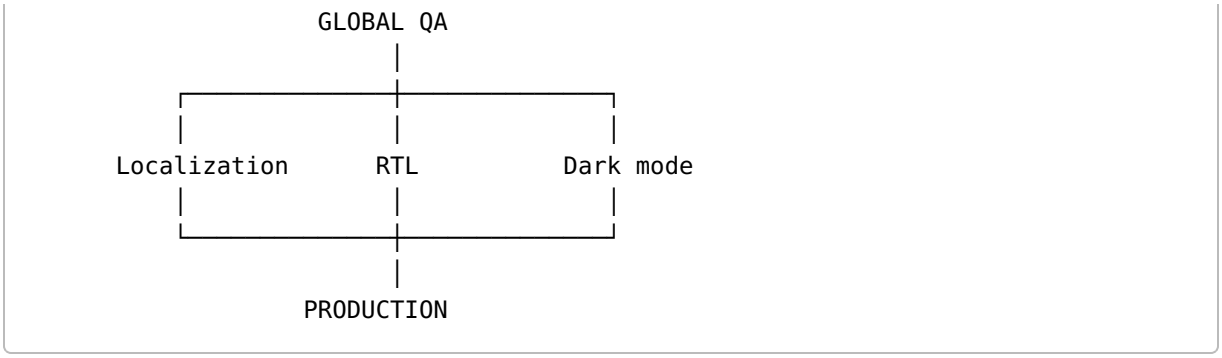
- [ ] Smooth scrolling
- [ ] No main-thread blocking
- [ ] Image optimization
- [ ] Efficient animations
- [ ] Fast startup

---

53. PixiJoy Screen Quality Gate

No screen should move to production unless it passes:



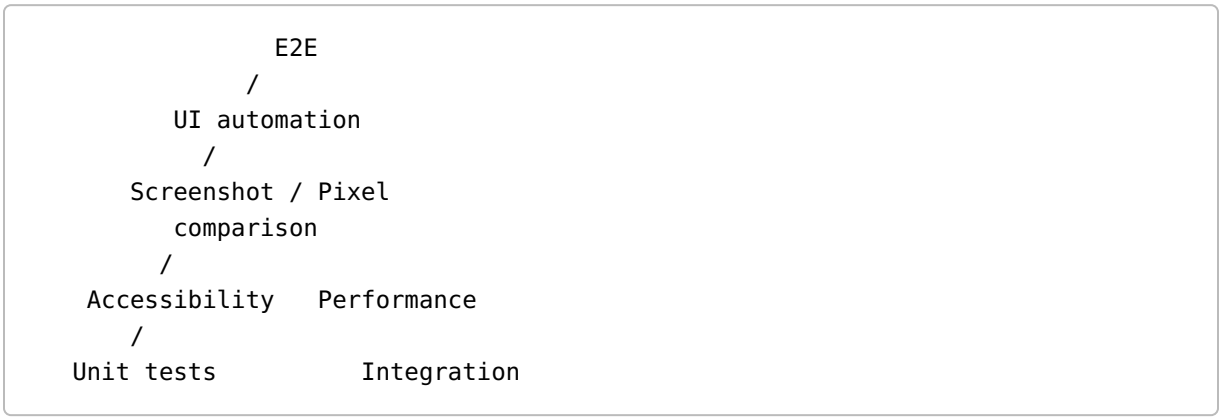


---

54. Automated UI/UX Quality

PixiJoy should eventually automate as much of this as possible.

The testing pyramid should include:



Automated checks should cover:

- UI screenshots
- Pixel differences
- Accessibility
- Content descriptions
- Touch targets
- Dark mode
- Font scaling
- Localization
- RTL
- Navigation
- Rotation
- Foldable layouts
- Network failures
- Offline mode

- Permission flows
- Process death
- Configuration changes
- Back navigation
- Deep links

This is especially important because PixiJoy is intended to be a **global-scale Android product**.

---

55. Design Tokens

PixiJoy should eventually maintain a central token system.

Example:

```
pixi.color.primary
pixi.color.background
pixi.color.surface

pixi.spacing.xs
pixi.spacing.sm
pixi.spacing.md
pixi.spacing.lg

pixi.radius.small
pixi.radius.medium
pixi.radius.large

pixi.typography.display
pixi.typography.headline
pixi.typography.title
pixi.typography.body
pixi.typography.caption

pixi.motion.fast
pixi.motion.normal
pixi.motion.slow
```

Designers and developers should consume the same tokens.

---

56. Figma → Android Rule

The Figma design must not be treated as a picture.

It should map to:

```
Figma
  ↓
Design Tokens
  ↓
Reusable Components
  ↓
Compose Components
  ↓
Screens
  ↓
Automated UI Tests
```

This prevents every screen from becoming a custom implementation.

---

57. Component Library

PixiJoy should maintain a reusable component library.

Minimum:

```
PixiButton
PixiIconButton
PixiTextField
PixiCard
PixiChip
PixiTopBar
PixiBottomBar
PixiNavigation
PixiBottomSheet
PixiDialog
PixiSnackbar
PixiLoading
PixiSkeleton
PixiEmptyState
PixiErrorState
PixiImage
PixiAvatar
PixiSection
PixiTab
PixiProgress
```

Every component should have documented states.

---

58. Definition of "Done"

A PixiJoy screen is **NOT DONE** when:

> "The UI looks correct in Figma."

It is done only when:

```
Design
  +
Implementation
  +
Accessibility
  +
Localization
  +
Dark mode
  +
Adaptive layout
  +
Performance
  +
Error handling
  +
Automated testing
  +
Real-device validation
```

are complete.

---

59. PixiJoy Golden Rule

> **Beautiful when static.**
>
> **Delightful when interacting.**
>
> **Fast when loading.**
>
> **Forgiving when users make mistakes.**

Accessible to everyone.

Adaptive everywhere.

Predictable on every Android device.

This is the PixiJoy standard.